

25VECV06960 25VECV06960

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: U

Hearing date: 2026-07-13

Motion: DEFENDANTS SOHEIL GOEL AND GOEL BUSINESS CORPORATION'S DEMURRER TO PLAINTIFFS' FIRST AMENDED COMPLAINT

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Case Number: 25VECV06960 Hearing Date: July 13, 2026 Dept: U

SUPERIOR COURT OF
THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA

FOR
THE COUNTY OF LOS ANGELES - NORTHWEST DISTRICT

FARZAN ALAMIRAD,
an individual; and DEANNA ALAMIRAD, an individual,

Plaintiffs,

vs.

LEYLA SOLYMANI ZANJANI, an individual;
ESRAFIL HERVANI, an individual; SHAYAN HERVANI, an individual; NOURA HERVANI
a/k/a DR. NOURA AGHAEI HERVANI, DDS, NPI 1710685789, an individual; FATAME
TEHRANI a/k/a SIMIN TEHRANI, an individual; NADI MIRVAHABI, an individual;
NADREH HADJI MIRVAHABIL, an individual; SOHEIL GOEL, an individual; GOEL
BUSINESS CORPORATION, a California corporation; and DOES 1-50, inclusive,

Defendants.

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CASE NO: 25VECV06960

[TENTATIVE] ORDER RE: DEFENDANTS SOHEIL

GOEL AND GOEL BUSINESS CORPORATION'S DEMURRER TO PLAINTIFFS' FIRST AMENDED COMPLAINT

Dept. U

8:30 a.m.

July 13, 2026

1.

BACKGROUND

This case arises from a dispute between tenants (father and daughter), their former landlords, and other landlord-affiliated parties.

On December 8, 2025, Plaintiffs

Farzan

Alamirad ("Farzan") and Deanna Alamirad ("Deanna") filed their original complaint against Defendants Leyla Solymani Zanjani ("Zanjani"); Esrafil Hervani ("Esrafil"); Shayan Hervani ("Shayan"); Noura Hervani a/k/a Dr. Noura Aghaei Hervani, DDS, NPI 1710685789 ("Noura"); Fatame Tehrani a/k/a Simin Tehrani ("Tehrani"); Nadi Mirvahabi ("Nadi"); Nadreh Hadji Mirvahabil ("Nadreh"); Soheil Goel ("Soheil"); and Goel Business Corporation ("GBC"), alleging: (1) wrongful eviction against Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura; (2) abuse of process against Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura; (3) intentional infliction of emotional distress ("IIED") against all Defendants; (4) animal cruelty against Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura; (5) conversion against Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura; (6) defamation against Zanjani, Tehrani, Soheil, Nadi, and Nadreh; (7) disability discrimination against Tehrani, Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura; (8) harassment against Tehrani, Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura; (9) private nuisance against Tehrani; (10) premises liability against Tehrani; (11) breach of contract against Tehrani; (12) retaliation against Tehrani; (13) tortious interference with contract against Zanjani and Soheil; (14) fraud against Zanjani, Nadi, and Nadreh; (15) malicious prosecution against Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura; (16) false light invasion of privacy against all Defendants; (17) elder abuse against all Defendants; and (18) fraud on the court / spoliation of evidence against Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, Noura, and Nadi.[1]

On March 4, 2026, the Court sustained, with leave to amend, Soheil and GBC's demurrer to the original complaint.

On March 16, 2026, Plaintiffs filed their first amended complaint (the "FAC"), alleging: (1) wrongful eviction against Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura; (2) abuse of process against Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura; (3) IIED against all Defendants; (4) negligence against Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura; (5) conversion against Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura; (6) defamation against Zanjani, Tehrani, Soheil, Nadi, and Nadreh; (7) disability discrimination against Tehrani, Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura; (8) harassment against Tehrani, Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura; (9) private nuisance against Tehrani; (10) premises liability against Tehrani; (11) breach of contract against Tehrani; (12) retaliation against Tehrani; (13) intentional interference with contract against Zanjani and Soheil; (14) fraud against Zanjani, Nadi, and Nadreh; (15) malicious prosecution against Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura; (16) false light invasion of privacy against all Defendants;

and (17) elder abuse against all Defendants.

On April 1, 2026,
Soheil and GBC filed their demurrer to the FAC and motion to strike portions thereof. (Going forward herein, the Court will refer to Soheil and GBC as the “Goel Parties.”)

On April 24, 2026,
Plaintiffs filed their opposition brief.

On June 26, 2026, the
Goel Parties filed their reply brief.

II.

LEGAL STANDARD

A demurrer is a procedure to object to a pleading set forth under Code of Civil Procedure section 430.10, et seq. Because a demurrer tests the pleadings alone and not the evidence or other extrinsic matters, a demurrer analysis considers only those defects which appear on the face of the pleading or are judicially noticed. *SKF Farms v. Superior Court* (1984) 153 Cal.App.3d 902, 905. When considering demurrers, courts assume the truth of the facts alleged in the pleading and read the allegations liberally and in context. *Schifando v. City of Los Angeles* (2003) 31 Cal.4th 1074, 1081.

A demurrer for sufficiency attacks a pleading on the ground that it does not contain facts sufficient to state a cause of action. Code Civ. Proc., § 430.10 (e); *Hahn v. Mirda* (2007) 147 Cal.App.4th 740, 747. Parties may also demur to causes of action individually. In either case, the procedure is also called a ‘demurrer for sufficiency,’ and it tests the pleading by itself, alone and disconnected from extraneous matters. *Hahn*, at p. 747.

III.

DISCUSSION

The Goel Parties demur to the following causes of action in the FAC: (3) IIED; (6) defamation; (13) tortious interference with contract; (16) false light invasion of privacy; and (17) elder abuse. The Goel Parties also move to strike various portions of the FAC.

Review of Allegations in the FAC

Plaintiffs

plead Farzan is a licensed dentist, age 63, suffering from serious medical vulnerability, disability-related limitations, heat sensitivity, and the effects of prior medical trauma. Plaintiffs

plead Deanna is a young adult residing with her father and preparing for college. Plaintiffs newly plead that

Farzan was, at all relevant times, a “dependent adult” due to physical or mental limitations restricting his ability to carry out normal activities or protect his rights, including a reduced ability to safely withstand extreme stress, housing displacement, and coordinated harassment. Plaintiffs’ complaint addresses their prior tenancy at 7830 Lena Avenue in West Hills (the “West Hills Property”) and their later tenancy at 23111 Burbank Boulevard in Woodland Hills (the “Woodland Hills Property”). (FAC, p. 2:5-24.)

Plaintiffs

plead Zanjani and Esrafil were landlord or landlord-affiliated parties at the West Hills Property. Plaintiffs plead

Shayan and Noura are individuals who participated in the conduct alleged, including the eviction events, recording, and harassment. Plaintiffs plead Tehrani is Plaintiffs’ landlord or landlord-affiliated party at the Woodland Hills Property. Plaintiffs plead Nadi participated in the creation, alteration, or dissemination of false or manipulated media and statements concerning Plaintiffs and Nadreh participated in the dissemination of that false, misleading, or defamatory content. (FAC, p. 3:5-23.)

Plaintiffs

plead Soheil is an individual residing in California and a close associate of one or more of the other Defendants. Plaintiffs

plead GBC is owned, controlled, managed, or directed by Soheil. Plaintiffs newly and more specifically plead that Soheil used GBC’s “business identity, business channels, business relationships, devices, communication platforms, and/or business-affiliated groups” (including business telephones, business text threads, business WhatsApp groups, business email accounts, professional contacts, and business community channels) to publish, republish, or facilitate defamatory statements, to interfere with Plaintiffs’ contractual and prospective economic relationships, and to amplify the campaign alleged in the pleading. Plaintiffs plead GBC ratified, approved, benefited from, or failed to prevent Soheil’s wrongful conduct while he was

acting within the course and scope of his authority for GBC. (FAC, pp. 3:24-4:14.)

Plaintiffs

plead Soheil, Tehrani, and Zanjani-affiliated parties, engaged in a coordinated campaign that amplified and reinforced the harm inflicted on Plaintiffs. Plaintiffs plead Tehrani demonstrated knowledge of non-public details from the West Hills unlawful detainer proceeding, including the eviction circumstances, Deanna's involvement, and the monetary amount of the judgment.

Plaintiffs plead this is evidence that Tehrani communicated and shared information with other Defendants involved in the eviction and litigation disputes. Plaintiffs plead Soheil likewise communicated with one or more Defendants regarding Plaintiffs and encouraged negative portrayals of Farzan in community and social settings, and that these statements were repeated and amplified by others within the same social and community circles. (FAC, pp. 5:16-6:6.)

Plaintiffs

plead this action arises from their 2024 lease of the West Hills Property, and that on April 29, 2025, a default judgment was entered in an unlawful detainer matter concerning that property. Plaintiffs plead service in that unlawful detainer proceeding was defective and that the judgment and subsequent enforcement actions were tainted by procedural and factual misconduct. Plaintiffs plead that, during the tenancy, landlord-affiliated Defendants engaged in a course of wrongful conduct including utility-related misconduct, habitability-related misconduct, harassment, pressure tactics, and efforts to force Plaintiffs out. (FAC, p. 11:9-17.)

Plaintiffs

plead that on August 13, 2025, they were subjected to an eviction under highly traumatic and hostile circumstances.

Plaintiffs plead armed sheriffs entered the West Hills Property after Defendants falsely represented to authorities that Farzan possessed a firearm, and that officers approached the residence aggressively, banging loudly on the door and entering with weapons drawn. Plaintiffs plead they had substantially completed moving out, yet Defendants escalated the event in a manner designed to maximize humiliation, force, intimidation, and damage. Plaintiffs plead Shayan verbally insulted and harassed Plaintiffs during the eviction. (FAC, pp. 7:8-10, 11:18-27.)

Plaintiffs

newly plead that the forced eviction caused direct harm to Plaintiffs' two cats, which were severely frightened and traumatized by the armed entry, shouting, and sudden presence of strangers.

Plaintiffs plead the cats were left briefly inside the residence with unfamiliar individuals and that, when recovered, the cats displayed extreme fear behaviors and became withdrawn. (FAC, p. 7:15-27.)

Plaintiffs

plead that video materials and related files used in support of restraining-order or eviction-related proceedings had been altered, manipulated, selectively edited, or republished in misleading form. Plaintiffs plead one or more Defendants participated in changing metadata, suppressing exculpatory audio, altering sequencing, changing file creation or modification characteristics, and creating new URLs or replacement links to present manipulated materials to courts and third parties as authentic. Plaintiffs plead they raised these issues, but the altered materials nevertheless caused severe legal, emotional, housing, reputational, and professional harm. (FAC, p. 12:1-9.)

Plaintiffs

plead that, in addition to the landlord-related Defendants, Soheil participated in the campaign against Plaintiffs by publishing false and injurious statements and encouraging others to view Plaintiffs as unstable, dangerous, dishonest, or socially unworthy. Specifically, Plaintiffs

plead that in a group text exchange with approximately eight (8) participants, Soheil referred to Farzan as a "cockroach," posted images of cockroaches to ridicule him, and wrote, among other things: "I cannot believe myself responding to a cockroach"; "Good luck harumzadeh"; "Learn how to spell it idiot"; "Small man"; "God created different retards but you are a completely unique one"; and that he would "forward the husband to f*** you and your entire family cockroach." Plaintiffs newly

plead that Soheil stated or implied that Farzan suffered from schizophrenia or other serious mental illness, was not mentally fit, and posed a danger to others. Plaintiffs plead such allegations are false and constitute defamation per se because they attack the professional competence and trustworthiness required for the practice of dentistry. (FAC, pp. 12:10-14:5.)

Plaintiffs

plead Farzan and Soheil operate within the same dental and community market and

share potential patients and referral relationships. Plaintiffs plead patients and potential patients were diverted away from Farzan and toward Soheil and GBC as Farzan's reputation was damaged by these publications.

Plaintiffs plead GBC benefitted economically from the reputational harm inflicted on Farzan, including through increased patient opportunities, business advantage, and competitive positioning. (FAC, p. 14:6-14.)

Plaintiffs

plead Tehrani appeared at Farzan's place of business and loudly made derogatory statements concerning him within hearing distance of patients and staff, disrupting the peaceful operation of the dental practice and damaging his professional relationships. Plaintiffs

plead Deanna's own harm included the loss of her opportunity to properly begin and attend her first semester of college as a direct result of the eviction, displacement, and ongoing harassment. (FAC, pp. 8:2-5, 10:16-19.)

Plaintiffs

newly plead Soheil knowingly participated in conduct exploiting Farzan's age, medical vulnerability, and economic dependence on his professional reputation, including conduct that interfered with his housing stability and professional livelihood. Plaintiffs plead Soheil knowingly targeted Farzan's age-related and medical vulnerability by publishing statements calculated to deprive him of housing stability, community support, patient trust, and economic security. (FAC, pp. 16:3-6, 27:1-8.)

Plaintiffs

plead Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura owed Plaintiffs a duty of reasonable care in connection with the eviction process.

Plaintiffs plead Zanjani, Esrafil, Shayan, and Noura breached that duty by acting unreasonably and in a manner that foreseeably endangered, frightened, or traumatized Plaintiffs' animals. (FAC, p. 18:16-27.)

a.

The pendency of case # 24VECV02362

is not a proper ground for the Goel Parties' demurrer because the two (2) cases arise from a fundamentally different set of disputes.

The

Goel Parties demur to the FAC on grounds that “[t]here is another action pending between the same parties on the same cause of action.” See Code Civ. Proc., § 430.10 (c). Specifically, the Goel Parties cite case #24VECV02362, wherein at least Soheil (though apparently not also GBC) is named as a cross-defendant in Farzan’s second amended cross-complaint.

The Court has reviewed the second amended cross-complaint filed in case #24VECV02362. While that pleading names some (though not all) of the same parties as does the operative pleading in this case and includes some of the same causes of action, the allegations in case #24VECV02362 arise from a fundamentally different set of disputes.

In case #24VECV02362, Farzan generally alleges that Soheil defamed him by helping to conceal asset misappropriation by individuals named Katherin Cohan and Azadeh Honarpour. Soheil also allegedly told certain individuals that Farzan’s dental practice was unsafe. These allegations present a fundamentally different dispute than do the allegations in this case, where Plaintiffs allege Defendants engaged in tortious conduct surrounding Plaintiffs’ eviction and shared derogatory remarks about Farzan in a group chat.

Because Plaintiffs’ allegations in this case do not arise from the same essential dispute as do Plaintiffs’ claims in case #24VECV02362, the pendency of case #24VECV02362 is not a proper ground for the Goel Parties’ demurrer.

b. The FAC is not uncertain because Plaintiffs’ allegations are generally sufficient for the Goel Parties to know and understand what claims against them would need to be admitted or denied.

The Goel Parties demur to each cause of action alleged against them in the FAC on grounds of uncertainty.

Generally, Plaintiffs allege improper conduct related to an earlier unlawful detainer proceeding and a proceeding to obtain a restraining order against Farzan. As to Soheil, Plaintiffs allege Soheil called Farzan a “cockroach” and used coarse language in group text messages. Plaintiffs also allege Tehrani was influenced

by Soheil to harass Plaintiffs with false accusations and to spread lies about Plaintiffs in the local Persian community.

Plaintiffs'

allegations are generally sufficient for Soheil to know and understand what claims against him, if otherwise sufficient, would need to be admitted or denied. Plaintiffs' claims that Soheil called Farzan a "cockroach" in group text messages puts Soheil on notice as to the type of denial he should fashion in this case (e.g., being called a "cockroach" is not legal grounds for defamation).

As

to GBC, Plaintiffs allege Soheil used GBC's "business identity, business channels, business relationships, devices, communication platforms, and/or business-affiliated groups" (including business telephones, business text threads, business WhatsApp groups, business email accounts, professional contacts, and business community channels) to publish, republish, or facilitate defamatory statements, to interfere with Plaintiffs' contractual and prospective economic relationships, and to amplify the campaign alleged in the pleading. (FAC, pp. 3:24-4:14.) This is sufficient for GBC to know and understand what claims against it would, if otherwise sufficient, need to be admitted or denied (e.g., that Farzan was or was not acting in his capacity as GBC's owner/agent when he made the allegedly false statements).

The

demurrer for uncertainty is overruled.

c.

Plaintiffs' allegations are insufficient to support claims for defamation and false light because Soheil's language, as alleged, is fairly characterized as rhetorical hyperbole rather than a provably false defamatory statement.

The

Goel Parties demur to Plaintiffs' sixth cause of action for defamation and sixteenth cause of action for false light.

The necessary elements

for defamation are: (1) the intentional publication by a defendant; (2) of a statement of fact; (3) that is false; (4) defamatory; (5) unprivileged; and (6)

has a natural tendency to injure or that causes special damages. *Taus v. Loftus* (2007) 40 Cal.4th 683, 720.

The necessary elements

for false light are: (1) a statement which was false; (2) and unprivileged; (3) published by writing, printing, or other fixed representation; (4) which exposes a person to hatred, contempt, ridicule, or obloquy, or which causes person to be shunned or avoided, or which has a tendency to injure person in his occupation; and (5) malice as to public figures.

Briscoe v. Reader's Digest Ass'n (1971) 4 Cal.3d 529, 543 (false light cause of action substantially the same as trade libel), overruled on other grounds by *Gates v. Discovery Communications, Inc.* (2004) 34 Cal.4th 679, 697.

For language to constitute libel or defamation, the subject statement needs to be provably false; “rhetorical hyperbole, vigorous epithets, lusty and imaginative expressions of contempt, and language used in a loose, figurative sense have all been accorded constitutional protection.” *Ferlauto v. Hamsher* (1999) 74 Cal.App.4th 1394, 1401 (*Ferlauto*) (cleaned up). “Use of hyperbolic, informal [citation], crude, or ungrammatical language, satirical tone, or vituperative, juvenile name-calling provide support for the conclusion that offensive comments were nonactionable opinion.” *ZL Technologies, Inc. v. Does 1–7* (2017) 13 Cal.App.5th 603, 624, citing *Chaker v. Mateo* (2012) 209 Cal.App.4th 1138, 1149-1150 (claiming plaintiff “pick[ed] up streetwalkers and homeless drug addicts and [was] a deadbeat dad” was nonactionable).

Plaintiffs allege Soheil called Farzan

a “cockroach,” used coarse language, and included graphic images of cockroaches in group text messages. Plaintiffs

allege Tehrani was influenced by Soheil to harass Plaintiffs with false accusations and to spread lies about Plaintiffs in the local Persian community. Plaintiffs include no

clarifying specifics as to Soheil's alleged influence over Tehrani. As to specific statements, Plaintiffs plead that in a group text exchange with approximately eight (8) participants, Soheil referred to Farzan as a “cockroach,” posted images of cockroaches to ridicule him, and wrote, among other things: “I cannot believe myself responding to a cockroach”; “Good luck harumzadeh”; “Learn how to spell it idiot”; “Small man”; “God created different retards but you are a completely unique one”; and that

he would “forward the husband to f*** you and your entire family cockroach.” (FAC, pp. 12:10-14:5.)

In

its current form, the FAC is still insufficient to show Soheil’s statements about Farzan were provably false.

Rather, Plaintiffs’ allegations show Soheil expressed a highly negative opinion of Farzan using hyperbolic, crude, and satirical language that was intended to convey Soheil’s distaste for Farzan rather than to convey that Farzan was, in fact, a cockroach. Such unserious, hyperbolic language is constitutionally protected and cannot form the basis of claims for defamation and false light. See *Ferlauto*, supra, 74 Cal.App.4th at p. 1401. The same is true of Plaintiffs’ allegations that Soheil called Farzan an “idiot,” a “small man,” and a “retard.”

Plaintiffs

also allege that Soheil stated or implied that Farzan suffered from schizophrenia or other serious mental illness, was not mentally fit, and posed a danger to others. Plaintiffs allege such allegations are false and constitute defamation per se because they attack the professional competence and trustworthiness required for the practice of dentistry. If Soheil published specific statements regarding Farzan’s mental health diagnoses that were, in fact, false, Plaintiffs would need to allege what precisely Soheil said regarding Farzan’s mental health and the medium in which it was published. Merely alleging that Soheil made general statements regarding Farzan’s mental health without specifying what exactly Soheil said and to whom is insufficient. Again, merely alleging that Soheil called Farzan, e.g., an “idiot” or a “retard” is insufficient. Plaintiffs have already been informed by the Court the type of allegations needed to constitute defamation rather than rhetorical hyperbole. They have not done it as to earlier allegations or new allegations. As such, the Court concludes they cannot do so.

The

demurrer is sustained, without leave to amend, as to Plaintiffs’ sixth cause of action for defamation and sixteenth cause of action for false light against the Goel Parties.

d.

Plaintiffs' IIED claim fails for the same reason as Plaintiffs' defamation and false light claims.

The Goel Parties demur to Plaintiffs' third cause of action for IIED.

The necessary elements for IIED are: (1) outrageous conduct by the defendant; (2) which was intentional or reckless in nature; (3) severe emotional distress; and (4) causation. *Huntingdon Life Sciences, Inc. v. Stop Huntingdon Animal Cruelty USA, Inc.* (2005) 129 Cal.App.4th 1228, 1259. Behavior may be considered outrageous if a defendant: (a) abuses a relation or position which gives him power to damage the plaintiff's interest; (b) knows the plaintiff is susceptible to injuries through mental distress; or (c) acts intentionally or unreasonably with the recognition that the acts are likely to result in illness through mental distress. *Stoiber v. Honeychuck* (1980) 101 Cal.App.3d 903, 921.

Here, Plaintiffs' IIED claim fails for the same reason as Plaintiffs' defamation and false light claims. While Plaintiffs have alleged that Soheil used insults and indignities in a group text to attack Farzan, such course and even grotesque language is, by itself, insufficient to show tortious conduct. See *Crouch v. Trinity Christian Center of Santa Ana, Inc.* (2019) 39 Cal.App.5th 995, 1007 ("Liability for IIED does not extend to mere insults, indignities, threats, annoyances, petty oppressions, or other trivialities").

Additionally, as noted above, Plaintiffs fail to allege specific symptoms of emotional distress that were caused by Soheil's alleged conduct. Given that Plaintiffs already had an opportunity to amend the IIEC claims, the Court sustains the demurrer to the IIED claim against the Goel Defendants without leave to amend.

e. Plaintiffs' allegations are insufficient to support claims for tortious interference with contract and elder abuse against the Goel Parties.

The Goel Parties demur to Plaintiffs' thirteenth cause of action for tortious interference with contract and seventeenth cause

of action for elder abuse.

The necessary elements

for intentional interference with contract are: (1) the existence of a valid contract between the plaintiff and a third party; (2) the defendant's knowledge of the contract; (3) the defendant's intentional acts designed to induce a breach or disruption of the contractual relationship; (4) actual breach or disruption of the contractual relationship; and (5) resulting damage. *Reeves v. Hanlon* (2004) 33 Cal.4th 1140, 1148.

The necessary elements

for a dependent adult abuse cause of action are: (1) that the defendant had responsibility for meeting the basic needs of the dependent adult, such as nutrition, hydration, hygiene or medical care; (2) that the defendant knew of conditions that made the dependent adult unable to provide for his own basic needs; (3) that the defendant denied or withheld goods or services necessary to meet the dependent adult's basic needs, either (a) with knowledge that injury was substantially certain to befall the dependent adult (if the plaintiff alleges oppression, fraud or malice) or (b) with conscious disregard of the high probability of such injury (if the plaintiff alleges recklessness); and (4) that the defendant's neglect caused the dependent adult to suffer physical harm, pain or mental suffering. *Carter v. Prime Healthcare Paradise Valley LLC* (2011) 198 Cal.App.4th 396, 407.

Plaintiffs' allegations

are insufficient to state a claim for intentional interference with contract because Plaintiffs fail to allege Soheil knew of the existence of any specific contract between Plaintiffs and a third party. Plaintiffs generally allege patients and potential patients were diverted away from Farzan and toward Soheil and GBC as Farzan's reputation was damaged by Soheil's publications. However, Plaintiffs fail to specify any single contract that was diverted because of Soheil's alleged statements which, again, the Court has found do not constitute defamation. Merely alleging that Farzan lost business to Soheil is insufficient to show Soheil's interference with any specific business relationship or contract.

As to Plaintiffs'

allegation of elder abuse, Plaintiffs fail to allege Soheil was ever responsible for meeting Farzan's basic needs and/or that Soheil and GBC took financial

advantage of Farzan. Plaintiffs allege in a general way that Soheil targeted Farzan's age-related and medical vulnerability by publishing statements calculated to deprive him of housing stability, community support, patient trust, and economic security. Such a generalized statement without specific allegations showing financial exploitation is insufficient to support a claim for elder abuse.

The demurrer is sustained, without leave to amend (again, Plaintiffs were already given leave to amend these causes of action, and again failed to sufficiently allege them while also failing to address how they can successfully amend these causes of action), as to Plaintiffs' thirteenth cause of action for tortious interference with contract and seventeenth cause of action for elder abuse against the Goel Parties.

f. Because

Plaintiffs have no viable claim against the Goel Parties, the motion to strike is denied as moot.

The Goel Parties move to strike portions of the FAC. The Court has already determined that Plaintiffs' allegations in the FAC are insufficient to support any cause of action against the Goel Parties. Accordingly, the Goel Parties' motion to strike is denied as moot.

IV.

CONCLUSION

Defendants Soheil Goel and Goel Business Corporation's demurrer for uncertainty as to the First Amended Complaint filed by Plaintiffs Farzan Alamirad and Deanna Alamirad is OVERRULED.

Defendants Soheil Goel and Goel Business Corporation's demurrer for sufficiency is SUSTAINED, without leave to amend as to the defamation, false light, IIED and elder abuse causes of action alleged against them in the First Amended Complaint filed by Plaintiffs Farzan Alamirad and Deanna Alamirad

Defendants Soheil Goel and Goel Business Corporation are ORDERED to give notice.

DATED: July 13, 2026

Lee

Arian

Judge of the
Superior Court

[1] Plaintiffs are self-represented. See *Harding v. Collazo* (1986) 177 Cal.App.3d 1044, 1056 (self-represented litigants held to same standards applied to licensed attorneys); see also *Monastero v. Los Angeles Transit Co.* (1955) 131 Cal.App.2d 156, 160-161 (“litigant is permitted to present his own case, but, in so doing, should be restricted to the same rules of evidence and procedure as is required of those qualified to practice law before our courts”).